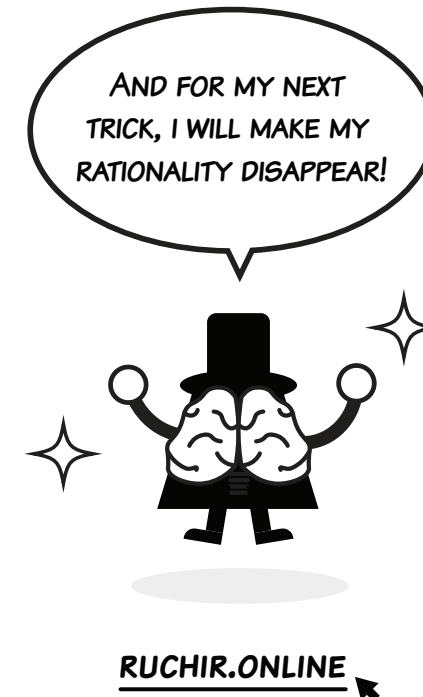
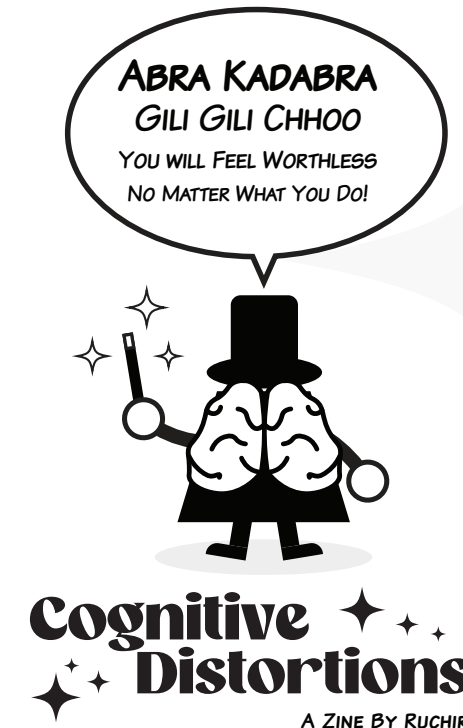


When Your Brain Plays Tricks on You

Cognitive Distortions are irrational or exaggerated thoughts that can lead to a negative perception of reality, even if it isn't accurate. They are used in Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT). Since I'm a visual person I came up with RPG-style icons for each of them. I'm presenting them here along with my interpretation.



-  **POLARIZED THINKING**
Thinking in black-and-white
all-or-nothing extremes
-  **MIND READING**
Assuming others' thoughts
without good evidence
-  **FORTUNE TELLING**
Predicting outcomes
without good evidence

-  **OVERGENERALIZATION**
Making broad generalizations
from little data
-  **LABELLING**
Assigning negative labels like
"loser" to self or others
-  **BLAMING**
Placing undue responsibility on
someone else without
good evidence

-  **GRATITUDE TRAP**
Shame due to feelings of
how things "should" be
-  **FALLACY OF CHANGE**
Unfairly expecting or pressuring
others to meet your demands
-  **MENTAL FILTERING**
Completely leaving out the
positives of a situation
to only focus on the negative

-  **ALWAYS BEING RIGHT**
Being unable to see
where you might be wrong
-  **SHOULD STATEMENTS**
Setting up rigid/
unrealistic expectations
-  **DISQUALIFYING THE POSITIVE**
Downplaying or discrediting
the positives of a situation

-  **CATASTROPHIZING**
Expecting the worst possible
outcome in a situation
-  **EMOTIONAL REASONING**
Believing something must
be true because it feels so
-  **PERSONALIZATION**
Placing undue responsibility on
yourself without good evidence